

25STCV03200 25STCV03200

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Case Number: 25STCV03200 Hearing Date: August 5, 2026 Dept: 406

MOHAMMAD REZA KARIMI,

Plaintiff,

v.

CONCORD COLLECTIVE PARTNERS, LLC, et

al.,

Defendants.

Case No.: 25STCV03200

Hearing Date: August 5, 2026

[TENTATIVE]

order RE:

plaintiff's motion to compel compliance

with prior court orders

BACKGROUND

On February 5, 2025, Plaintiff

Mohammad Reza Karimi filed this employment discrimination action against

Defendants Concord Collective Partners, LLC (Concord), SSP America, Inc. (SSP),

and Phillip Mangawang (Mangawang).

On April 22 and 27, 2026, the Court partially granted Plaintiff's motions to compel further responses from Concord and Mangawang to requests for production, requests for admission, and form interrogatories.

On June 22, 2026, Plaintiff filed the instant motion to compel compliance with the Court's April 22 and April 27 orders. Defendants filed an opposition on July 23, 2026. Plaintiff filed a reply on July 28, 2026.

DISCUSSION

I.

Concord's Supplemental Responses

a. FROG No. 217.1

FROG No. 217.1 asks for specific information pertaining to each response to RFAs that is not an unqualified admission. Concord's initial response was defective because it provided an omnibus response instead of providing discrete information on each RFA.

In its supplemental production, Concord provided a draft response with placeholders in lieu of substantive information. (Lavi Decl., Ex. 4.) Concord subsequently corrected this error by producing a response that provides substantive information for each individual subpart. (Hayden Decl., Ex. C.) Thus, Concord has resolved the defect with FROG No. 217.1.

b. RFAs

Concord's initial responses to RFA

Nos. 62-64 were defective because Concord claimed a lack of information but failed to affirm a reasonable inquiry. In its supplemental responses, Concord admitted RFA Nos. 62-64 without qualification. (Lavi Decl., Ex. 3.) Therefore, Concord has resolved the defect with RFA Nos. 62-64.

Plaintiff takes issue with Concord's newly asserted relevance objections that were not part of the original responses. In its opposition, Concord stipulates that its responses to RFA Nos.

62-64 are unqualified admissions “with the accompanying objections withdrawn.” (Opp. 6:4-6.) This resolves the issue.

II.

Mangawang’s Supplemental Responses

a. FROG No. 217.1

Mangawang’s initial response to FROG

No. 217.1 was defective because it provided an omnibus response instead of providing discrete information on each RFA. In his supplemental response, Mangawang provided discrete information for each RFA, but grouped some RFAs together where they pertain to the same topics and therefore involve the same facts, witnesses, and documents. This is a reasonable response. Mangawang need not copy and paste the exact same response for multiple RFAs that concern the same subject matter. Therefore, Mangawang has resolved the defect with FROG No. 217.1.

b. RFAs

1.

RFA No. 4

RFA No. 4 asks Mangawang to admit that Plaintiff is Iranian. Mangawang’s original response was deficient because he claimed a lack of knowledge without affirming a reasonable inquiry. Mangawang’s supplemental response states: “Admit that Plaintiff has identified himself as being of Iranian national origin. Responding Party has no independent personal knowledge of Plaintiff’s ancestry but, based upon Plaintiff’s own representations, admits.”

This is a reasonable response.

Mangawang is entitled to “reasonably and clearly qualif[y]” his admission or specify the part of the request for which he lacks sufficient knowledge. (See Code Civ. Proc., § 2033.220(b).) Mangawang followed the Code by stating that he has no independent personal knowledge of Plaintiff’s ancestry, but clarifying that he accepts Plaintiff’s representation that he is Iranian. Mangawang cannot be forced to have personal knowledge of someone else’s race or nationality. Mangawang admitted as much as he could, i.e., that Plaintiff has represented himself as Iranian. Therefore, Mangawang has resolved the defect

with RFA No. 4.

2. RFA No. 5

RFA No. 5 asks Mangawang to admit that Plaintiff injured his ankle while on duty in June 2023. Mangawang's original response was deficient because he claimed a lack of knowledge without affirming a reasonable inquiry. Mangawang's supplemental response states: "Admit that Plaintiff reported that he injured his ankle in or around June 2023 while on duty."

This is a reasonable qualification.

Mangawang admitted as much as possible, which is that Plaintiff reported an on-duty ankle injury in June 2023. Mangawang cannot be forced to have personal knowledge of whether Plaintiff actually injured his ankle. Therefore, Mangawang has resolved the defect with RFA No. 5.

Mangawang also stipulates to providing a further supplemental response that confirms a reasonable inquiry and states that Mangawang lacks sufficient knowledge to admit the remainder of the requests. (Opp. 11:13-17.) Therefore, the issue has been resolved.

CONCLUSION

Plaintiff's motion to compel compliance is GRANTED in part. Concord shall provide unqualified admissions to RFA Nos. 62-64 without objection. Mangawang shall provide supplemental responses to RFA Nos. 4 and 5 which confirm a reasonable inquiry and lack of knowledge. Sanctions are denied as the parties acted with substantial justification.